

Internal Quality Assurance Cell Rules — Rules Notification

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This rules notification gives effect to Internal Quality Assurance Cell Rules and covers the purposes, responsibilities and operating expectations associated with IQAC. It should be read alongside supporting guidance and any subsequent circulars.

Context and Background

The rules landscape has evolved considerably in recent years, and institutions under Directorate of Collegiate Education have responded with renewed attention to IQAC, Quality Assurance, Self-Assessment. This rules notification provides the framework needed to guide consistent practice across the sector.

Stakeholders across Directorate of Collegiate Education have emphasised the importance of IQAC as a foundation for credible, well-governed higher education. The present rules notification responds to that expectation by setting out clear, practical direction.

Purpose

This rules notification is intended to translate the objectives of Internal Quality Assurance Cell Rules into actionable direction for institutions, officials and other stakeholders, ensuring that IQAC is pursued in a structured and accountable manner.

By setting out the rationale, scope and operating expectations for IQAC, the document aims to reduce ambiguity, support institutional planning and improve the quality of Quality Assurance across the system.

Policy Objectives

This document seeks to enhance institutional capacity for IQAC, Quality Assurance, promote transparency in decision-making, and ensure that resources committed to related initiatives are used effectively.

In pursuing these objectives, Directorate of Collegiate Education intends to create conditions in which institutions can deliver consistent, high-quality outcomes in respect of IQAC, Quality Assurance, Self-Assessment, with clear lines of accountability.

Coverage

The provisions apply to all universities and colleges under Directorate of Collegiate Education. Sector partners, including employers and professional bodies, are expected to support implementation within their respective spheres.

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Core Provisions

Institutions are required to integrate IQAC, Quality Assurance into annual planning cycles, designate accountable officers, and maintain records demonstrating compliance with the expectations set out here.

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Implementation Pathway

A dedicated implementation pathway, covering readiness assessment, capacity building and progressive rollout, has been designed to allow institutions of varying size and maturity to comply.

Institutions are expected to appoint a lead authority for implementation, adapt the framework to local context, and report progress to Directorate of Collegiate Education in line with the prescribed cycle.

Roles and Responsibilities

Directorate of Collegiate Education provides policy direction, capacity support and performance oversight, while institutions translate the framework into operational practice and maintain day-to-day accountability.

Clear allocation of responsibility is expected at institutional level, with Directorate of Collegiate Education acting as the coordinating authority for evaluation, escalation and cross-institutional learning.

Monitoring Arrangements

Progress will be monitored through annual institutional returns, targeted reviews and outcome indicators maintained centrally by Directorate of Collegiate Education. Findings will inform guidance and, where necessary, corrective measures.

Closing Note

This document is designed to evolve with institutional experience. Feedback from stakeholders will shape refinements, ensuring that the framework remains practical, proportionate and fit for purpose.